

5xx Server Error HTTP Status Codes (500, 501, 502, 504)

What are 5xx Status Codes?

The server failed to fulfil a valid request. The problem is the **server's end**, not the client's request.

Category: 5xx (Server Error)

Key Point: The client's request was valid, but the server could not complete it due to an internal issue.

5xx Status Codes

Status Code 500:

- **Name:** Internal Server Error
- **Meaning:** Generic “catch-all” for unhandled exceptions, database connection failures, or unexpected server conditions
- **When to Use:** Unhandled exception, database down, null reference
- **ASP.NET Core Helper:** Automatic (framework) / StatusCode(500)

Status Code 501:

- **Name:** Not implemented
- **Meaning:** Server does not support the functionality required to fulfil the request, often because the HTTP method is not recognized
- **When to Use:** HTTP method not recognized, feature not implemented
- **ASP.NET Core Helper:** StatusCode(501)

Status Code 502:

- **Name:** Bad Gateway
- **Meaning:** Server acting as gateway/proxy receives invalid response from upstream server
- **When to Use:** API gateway cannot reach backend service
- **ASP.NET Core Helper:** StatusCode(502)

Status Code 503:

- **Name:** Service Unavailable

- **Meaning:** Server temporarily unable to handle requests, typically due to maintenance or being overloaded
- **When to Use:** Scheduled maintenance, server overload, rate limiting
- **ASP.NET Core Helper:** StatusCode(503)

Status Code 504:

- **Name:** Gateway Timeout
- **Meaning:** Gateway or proxy server did not receive timely response from upstream server
- **When to Use:** Backend service taking too long to response
- **ASP.NET Core Helper:** StatusCode(504)

More Bout 5xx Status Codes

Code	How It's Returned	Client Action
500	Usually automatic (unhandled exception). Can be manual.	Retry later. If persist, report to server admin.
501	Must be manual (feature not implemented or method not recognized).	Wait for API update or use different endpoint/method.
502	Must be manual (simulated gateway/proxy error).	Retry later. May indicate upstream service issue.
503	Must be manual (maintenance/overload).	Retry after some time. Check API status page.
504	Must be manual (simulated timeout).	Retry later. May indicate performance issue.

Now we are going to set up a project 'ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes' to represent the above concepts,

Project Setup

Create the project:

Command: dotnet new webapi -n ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes -f net8.0

Navigate to the project:

Command: cd ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes

Install Packages

Before installing the packages, we should make sure that we are in the project folder 'ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes' in terminal. If not, then navigate to the exact project folder in terminal.

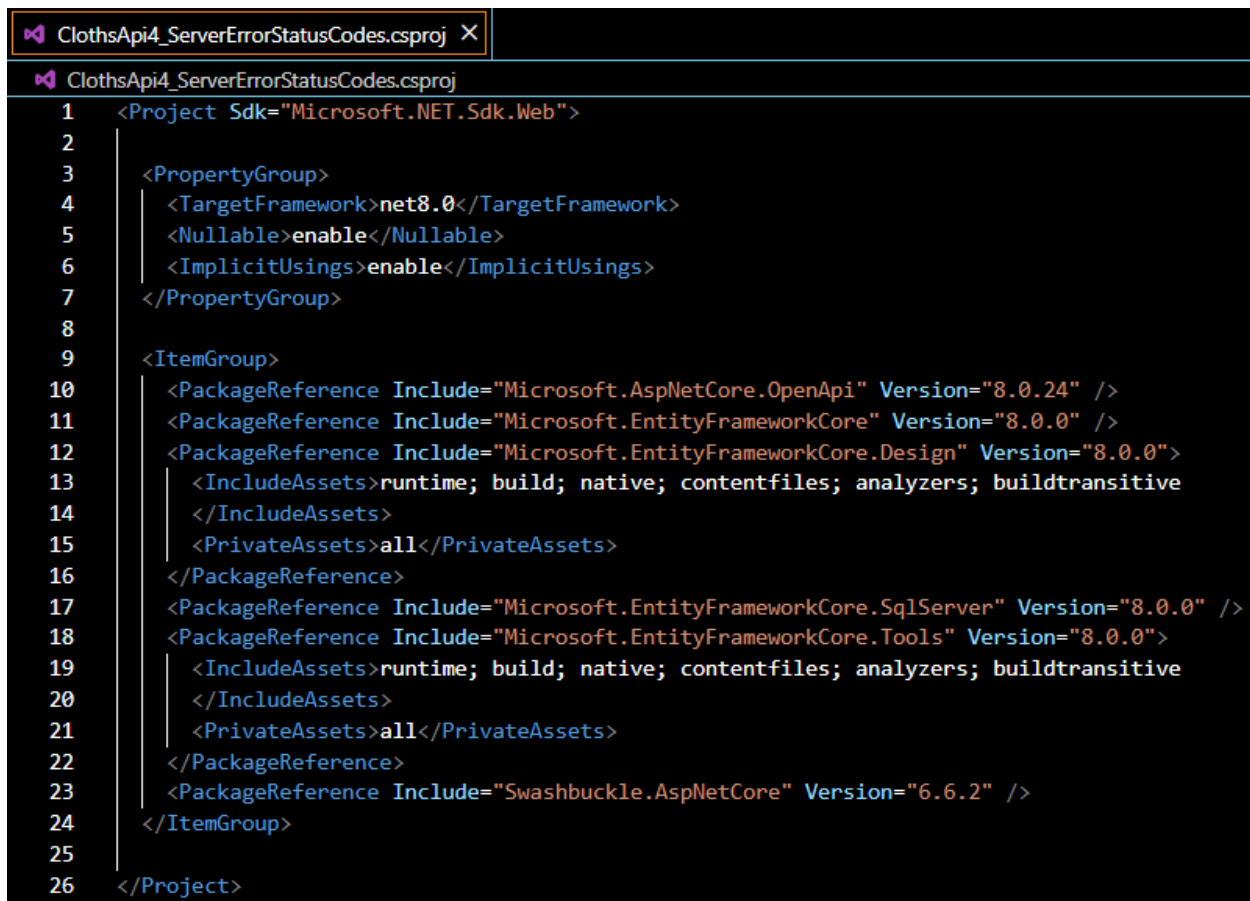
Command 1: dotnet add package Microsoft.EntityFrameworkCore --version 8.0.0

Command 2: dotnet add package Microsoft.EntityFrameworkCore.SqlServer --version 8.0.0

Command 3: dotnet add package Microsoft.EntityFrameworkCore.Tools --version 8.0.0

Command 4: dotnet add package Microsoft.EntityFrameworkCore.Design --version 8.0.0

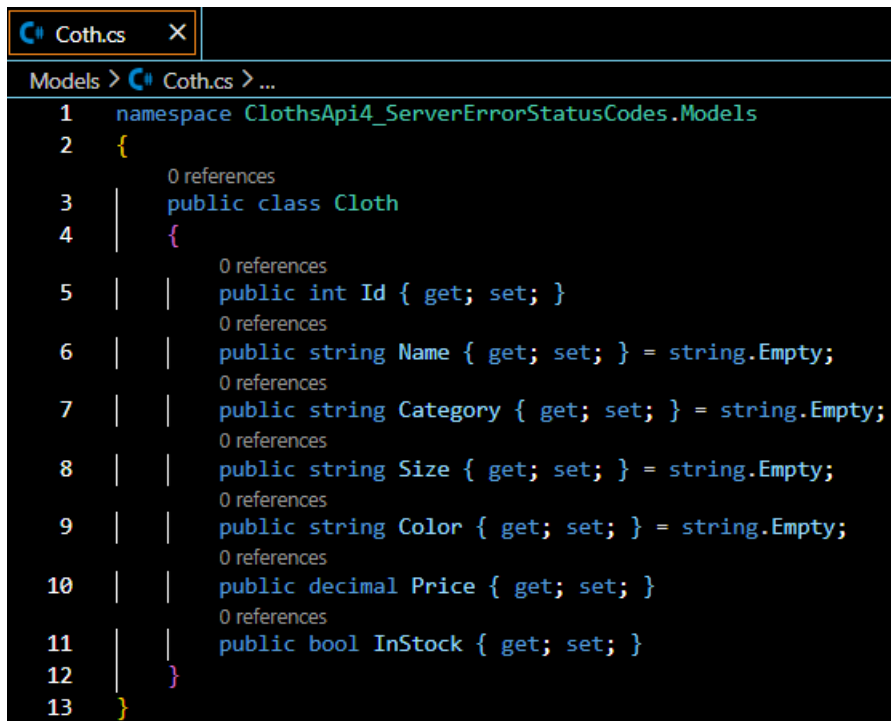
To check, whether the packages are successfully set up or not, we have to look over .csproj file,



```
1 <Project Sdk="Microsoft.NET.Sdk.Web">
2
3   <PropertyGroup>
4     <TargetFramework>net8.0</TargetFramework>
5     <Nullable>enable</Nullable>
6     <ImplicitUsings>enable</ImplicitUsings>
7   </PropertyGroup>
8
9   <ItemGroup>
10    <PackageReference Include="Microsoft.AspNetCore.OpenApi" Version="8.0.24" />
11    <PackageReference Include="Microsoft.EntityFrameworkCore" Version="8.0.0" />
12    <PackageReference Include="Microsoft.EntityFrameworkCore.Design" Version="8.0.0">
13      <IncludeAssets>runtime; build; native; contentfiles; analyzers; buildtransitive
14    </IncludeAssets>
15    <PrivateAssets>all</PrivateAssets>
16    </PackageReference>
17    <PackageReference Include="Microsoft.EntityFrameworkCore.SqlServer" Version="8.0.0" />
18    <PackageReference Include="Microsoft.EntityFrameworkCore.Tools" Version="8.0.0">
19      <IncludeAssets>runtime; build; native; contentfiles; analyzers; buildtransitive
20    </IncludeAssets>
21    <PrivateAssets>all</PrivateAssets>
22    </PackageReference>
23    <PackageReference Include="Swashbuckle.AspNetCore" Version="6.6.2" />
24  </ItemGroup>
25
26 </Project>
```

Step 1: Create Cloth Model

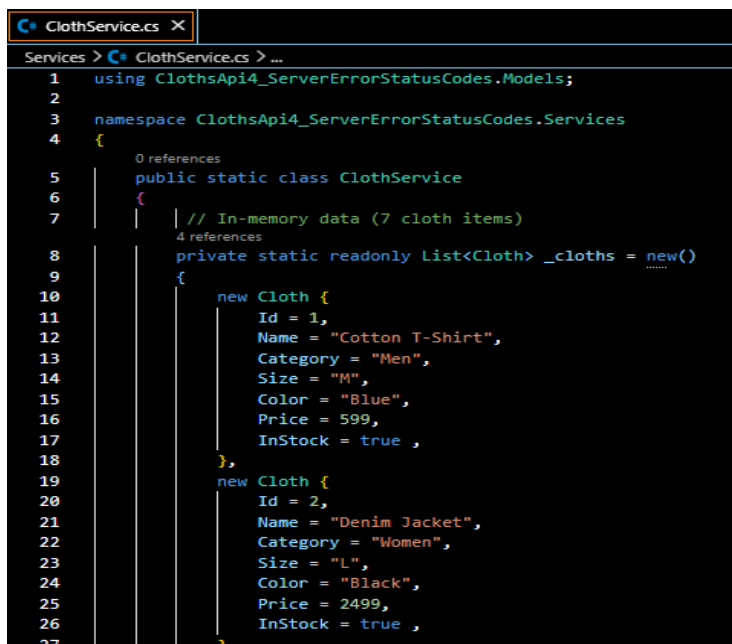
Path: ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes/Models/Cloth.cs



```
1 namespace ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes.Models
2 {
3     0 references
4     public class Cloth
5     {
6         0 references
7         public int Id { get; set; }
8         0 references
9         public string Name { get; set; } = string.Empty;
10        0 references
11        public string Category { get; set; } = string.Empty;
12        0 references
13        public string Size { get; set; } = string.Empty;
14        0 references
15        public string Color { get; set; } = string.Empty;
16        0 references
17        public decimal Price { get; set; }
18        0 references
19        public bool InStock { get; set; }
20    }
21 }
```

Step 2: Create Cloth Service (With Simulated Errors)

Path: ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes/Services/ClothService.cs



```
1 using ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes.Models;
2
3 namespace ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes.Services
4 {
5     0 references
6     public static class ClothService
7     {
8         // In-memory data (7 cloth items)
9         4 references
10        private static readonly List<Cloth> _cloths = new()
11        {
12            new Cloth {
13                Id = 1,
14                Name = "Cotton T-Shirt",
15                Category = "Men",
16                Size = "M",
17                Color = "Blue",
18                Price = 599,
19                InStock = true ,
20            },
21            new Cloth {
22                Id = 2,
23                Name = "Denim Jacket",
24                Category = "Women",
25                Size = "L",
26                Color = "Black",
27                Price = 2499,
28                InStock = true ,
29            },
30        };
31    }
32 }
```

<pre> 28 new Cloth { 29 Id = 3, 30 Name = "Formal Shirt", 31 Category = "Men", 32 Size = "XL", 33 Color = "White", 34 Price = 1299, 35 InStock = false, 36 }, 37 new Cloth { 38 Id = 4, 39 Name = "Sports Shoes", 40 Category = "Men", 41 Size = "9", 42 Color = "Grey", 43 Price = 3499, 44 InStock = true, 45 }, </pre>	<pre> 46 new Cloth { 47 Id = 5, 48 Name = "Silk Saree", 49 Category = "Women", 50 Size = "Free", 51 Color = "Red", 52 Price = 4999, 53 InStock = true, 54 }, 55 new Cloth { 56 Id = 6, 57 Name = "Kids Hoodie", 58 Category = "Kids", 59 Size = "S", 60 Color = "Yellow", 61 Price = 899, 62 InStock = true, 63 }, </pre>
---	---

```

64         new Cloth {
65             Id = 7,
66             Name = "Leather Belt",
67             Category = "Accessories",
68             Size = "32",
69             Color = "Brown",
70             Price = 399,
71             InStock = false,
72         }
73     };

```

```

74
75     // flag to simulate database connection failure (500)
76     2 references
77     public static bool SimulateDatabaseFailure { get; set; } = false;
78
79     // flag to simulate upstream service failure (502)
80     1 reference
81     public static bool SimulateUpstreamFailure { get; set; } = false;
82
83     // flag to simulate maintenance mode (503)
84     0 references
85     public static bool IsUnderMaintenance { get; set; } = false;
86
87     // flag to simulate slow response (504)
88     1 reference
89     public static bool SimulateSlowResponse { get; set; } = false;
90
91     // Get all cloths (can fail for 500 demo)
92     0 references
93     public static async Task<List<Cloth>> GetAllClothsAsync()
94     {
95         await Task.Delay(50);
96
97         // Simulate database connection failure --> 500 Internal Server Error
98         if(SimulateDatabaseFailure)
99             throw new Exception("Database connection failed. Unable to retrieve data.");
100
101         return _cloths;
102     }

```

```

98
99 // Get Cloth by ID (can fail for 500 demo)
   0 references
100 public static async Task<Cloth?> GetClothByIdAsync(int id)
101 {
102     await Task.Delay(30);
103
104     // Simulate database connection failure --> 500 Internal Server Error
105     if(SimulateDatabaseFailure)
106     {
107         throw new Exception("Database connection failed. Unable to retrieve data.");
108     }
109     return _cloths.FirstOrDefault(c => c.Id == id);
110 }
111
112 // Simulate upstream service call (for 502)
   0 references
113 public static async Task<string> CallUpstreamServiceAsync()
114 {
115     await Task.Delay(100);
116
117     if (SimulateUpstreamFailure)
118     {
119         return "invalid_response"; // Simulates invalid response from upstream
120     }
121     return "valid_response";
122 }

```

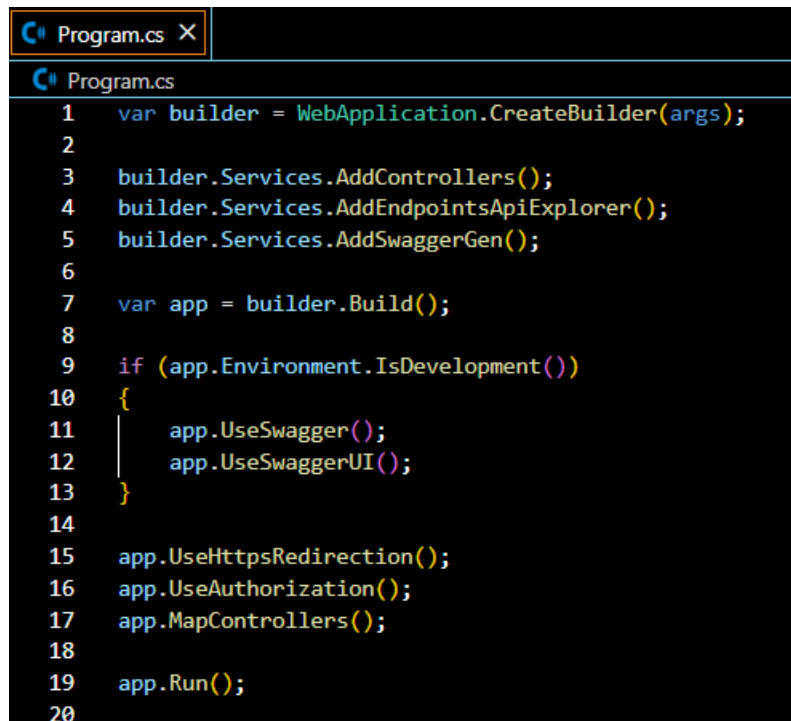
```

122 // Simulate slow upstream service (for 504)
   0 references
123 public static async Task<string> CallSlowUpstreamServiceAsync()
124 {
125     if (SimulateSlowResponse)
126     {
127         await Task.Delay(60000); // Simulate timeout (60 seconds)
128     }
129     else
130     {
131         await Task.Delay(100);
132     }
133     return "valid_response";
134 }
135
136 // Add new cloth
   0 references
137 public static async Task<Cloth> AddClothAsync(Cloth newCloth)
138 {
139     await Task.Delay(100);
140     newCloth.Id = _cloths.Max(c => c.Id) + 1;
141     _cloths.Add(newCloth);
142     return newCloth;
143 }
144 }

```

Step 3: Program.cs (Minimal)

Path: ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes/Program.cs



```
1  var builder = WebApplication.CreateBuilder(args);  
2  
3  builder.Services.AddControllers();  
4  builder.Services.AddEndpointsApiExplorer();  
5  builder.Services.AddSwaggerGen();  
6  
7  var app = builder.Build();  
8  
9  if (app.Environment.IsDevelopment())  
10 {  
11     app.UseSwagger();  
12     app.UseSwaggerUI();  
13 }  
14  
15 app.UseHttpsRedirection();  
16 app.UseAuthorization();  
17 app.MapControllers();  
18  
19 app.Run();  
20
```


Step 4: Controller (All 5xx Status Codes)

Path: ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes/Controllers/ClothController.cs

```
ClothController.cs X
Controllers > ClothController.cs > ...
1  using ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes.Models;
2  using ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes.Services;
3  using Microsoft.AspNetCore.Mvc;
4
5  namespace ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes.Controllers
6  {
7      [ApiController]
8      [Route("api/[controller]")]
9      public class ClothController : ControllerBase
10     {
11         // =====
12         // 500 INTERNAL SERVER ERROR
13         // Generic "catch-all" for unhandled exceptions,
14         // database connection failures,
15         // or unexpected server conditions.
16         // Returned automatically by framework for unhandled exceptions,
17         // Can also be manual: StatusCode(500)
18         // =====
19
20         // GET /api/Cloth?simulateError=true
21         // Returns 500 when database simulation is enabled
22         [HttpGet]
23         public async Task<ActionResult<List<Cloth>>> GetAllCloths(
24             [FromQuery] bool simulateError = false
25         )
26         {
27             if(simulateError)
28                 ClothService.SimulateDatabaseFailure = true;
29
30             try
31             {
32                 var cloths = await ClothService.GetAllClothsAsync();
33                 ClothService.SimulateDatabaseFailure = false;
34                 return Ok(cloths);
35             }
36             catch (Exception ex)
37             {
38                 ClothService.SimulateDatabaseFailure = false;
39                 // 500 Internal Server - unhandled exception
40                 return StatusCode(500, new { Error = "Internal Server Error", Message = ex.Message });
41             }
42         }
43     }
```

```

43
44 // GET /api/Cloth/500-manual/0
45 // Manual 500 response (without exception)
46 [HttpGet("500-manual/{id}")]
0 references
47 public async Task<ActionResult<Cloth>> GetClothManual500(int id)
48 {
49     if (id <= 0)
50     {
51         return StatusCode(500, new {
52             Error = "Internal Server Error",
53             Message = "Invalid ID caused server processing error."
54         });
55     }
56
57     var cloth = await ClothService.GetClothByIdAsync(id);
58
59     if (cloth == null)
60     {
61         return NotFound($"Cloth with ID {id} not found");
62     }
63
64     return Ok(cloth);
65 }
66

```

```

67 // =====
68 // 501 NOT IMPLEMENTED
69 // Server does not support the functionality required to fulfill the request,
70 // often because the HTTP method is not recognized or feature not implemented.
71 // Manual: StatusCode(501)
72 // =====
73
74 // POST /api/Cloth/bulk
75 // Returns 501 because bulk update is not yet implemented
76 [HttpPost("bulk")]
0 references
77 public IActionResult BulkCreateCloths()
78 {
79     return StatusCode(501, new
80     {
81         Error = "Not Implemented",
82         Message = "Bulk create operation is not yet implemented. Please use individual POST requests.",
83         PlannedRelease = "Q3 2026"
84     });
85 }
86
87 // PUT /api/Cloth/bulk-update
88 // Returns 501 because bulk update is not yet implemented
89 [HttpPut("bulk-update")]
0 references
90 public IActionResult BulkUpdateCloths()
91 {
92     return StatusCode(501, new
93     {
94         Error = "Not Implemented",
95         Message = "Bulk create operation is currently under development.",
96         PlannedRelease = "Q4 2026"
97     });
98 }
99

```

```

100 // =====
101 // 502 BAD GATEWAY
102 // Returned when a server acting as a gateway or proxy receives
103 // as invalid response from an upstream server.
104 // Manual: StatusCode(502)
105 // =====
106
107 // GET /api/Cloth/upstream?simulateError=true
108 // Returns 502 when upstream service returns invalid response
109 [HttpGet("upstream")]
110 0 references
111 public async Task<IActionResult> GetFromUpstream(
112     [FromQuery] bool simulateError = false
113 )
114 {
115     if (simulateError)
116         ClothService.SimulateUpstreamFailure = true;
117
118     var response = await ClothService.CallUpstreamServiceAsync();
119     ClothService.SimulateUpstreamFailure = false;
120
121     if (response != "valid_response")
122     {
123         // 502 Bad Gateway - Invalid response from upstream
124         return StatusCode(502, new
125         {
126             Error = "Bad Gateway",
127             Message = "The upstream server returned an invalid response.",
128             UpStreamResponse = response
129         });
130     }
131
132     return Ok(new
133     {
134         Message = "Upstream service respond successfully.",
135         Data = await ClothService.GetAllClothsAsync()
136     });
137 }

```

```

138 // =====
139 // 503 SERVICE UNAVAILABLE
140 // Server temporarily unable to handle requests,
141 // typically due to maintenance or being overloaded.
142 // Manual: StatusCode(503)
143 // =====
144
145 // GET /api/Cloth/maintenance
146 // Check maintenance status
147 [HttpGet("maintenance")]
148 0 references
149 public IActionResult CheckMaintenanceStatus()
150 {
151     if (ClothService.IsUnderMaintenance)
152     {
153         return StatusCode(503, new
154         {
155             Error = "Server Unavailable",
156             Message = "The API is currently under maintenance. Please try again later.",
157             EstimatedResumeTime = "2026-04-30T14:00:00Z"
158         });
159     }
160
161     return Ok(new
162     {
163         Status = "Operational",
164         Message = "API is running normally."
165     });
166 }

```

```

167 // POST /api/Cloth/maintenance/toggle?enable=true
168 // Toggle maintenance mode (for demo purposes)
169 [HttpPost("maintenance/toggle")]
    0 references
170 public IActionResult ToggleMaintenanceMode(
171     [FromQuery] bool enable
172 )
173 {
174     ClothService.IsUnderMaintenance = enable;
175     string status = enable ? "enabled" : "disabled";
176     return Ok(new
177     {
178         Message = $"Maintenance mode {status}",
179         MaintenanceMode = ClothService.IsUnderMaintenance
180     });
181 }
182
183 // GET /api/Cloth/all
184 // This endpoint checks maintenance flag before processing
185 [HttpGet("all")]
    0 references
186 public async Task<ActionResult<List<Cloth>>> GetAllClothsWithMaintenanceCheck()
187 {
188     if (ClothService.IsUnderMaintenance)
189     {
190         return StatusCode(503, new
191         {
192             Error = "Service Unavailable",
193             Message = "The API is currently under maintenance. Please try again later."
194         });
195     }
196
197     var cloths = await ClothService.GetAllClothsAsync();
198     return Ok(cloths);
199 }
200

```

```

200
201 // =====
202 // 504 GATEWAY TIMEOUT
203 // A gateway or proxy server did not receive a timely response
204 // from an upstream server
205 // Manual: StatusCode(504)
206 // =====
207

```

```

208 // GET /api/Cloth/timeout?simulateTimeout=true
209 // Returns 504 when upstream service times out
210 [HttpGet("timeout")]
    0 references
211 public async Task<IActionResult> GetWithTimeout(
212     [FromQuery] bool simulateTimeout = false
213 )
214 {
215     if (simulateTimeout)
216     {
217         ClothService.SimulateSlowResponse = true;
218     }
219
220     try
221     {
222         // Set a timeout of 5 seconds for this operation
223         using var cts = new
224             CancellationTokenSource(TimeSpan.FromSeconds(5));
225
226         var response = await ClothService.CallSlowUpstreamServiceAsync();
227         ClothService.SimulateSlowResponse = false;
228
229         return Ok(new
230             {
231                 Message = "Upstream service responded in time.",
232                 Data = response
233             });
234     }
235     catch (TaskCanceledException)
236     {
237         ClothService.SimulateSlowResponse = false;
238         // 504 Gateway Timeout - Upstream server did not respond in time
239         return StatusCode(504, new
240             {
241                 Error = "Gateway Timeout",
242                 Message = "The upstream server did not respond in time. Please try again later.",
243                 TimeoutSeconds = 5
244             });
245     }
246 }
247

```

```

248 // =====
249 // Normal working endpoints (for comparison)
250 // =====
251
252 // POST /api/cloth - Create new cloth
253 [HttpPost]
    0 references
254 public async Task<ActionResult<Cloth>> CreateCloth([FromBody] Cloth newCloth)
255 {
256     if (string.IsNullOrEmpty(newCloth.Name))
257         return BadRequest("Cloth name is required.");
258
259     if (ClothService.IsUnderMaintenance)
260         return StatusCode(503, "Service under maintenance. Please try again later.");
261
262     var createdCloth = await ClothService.AddClothAsync(newCloth);
263     return CreatedAtAction(nameof(GetClothById), new { id = createdCloth.Id }, createdCloth);
264 }
265

```

```
266 // GET /api/cloth/{id} - Get cloth by ID
267 [HttpGet("{id}")]
    1 reference
268 public async Task<ActionResult<Cloth>> GetClothById(int id)
269 {
270     if (ClothService.IsUnderMaintenance)
271         return StatusCode(503, "Service under maintenance. Please try again later.");
272
273     var cloth = await ClothService.GetClothByIdAsync(id);
274     if (cloth == null)
275         return NotFound($"Cloth with ID {id} not found");
276
277     return Ok(cloth);
278 }
279 }
280 }
281
```

Test our API – All Endpoints with Expected Responses

Let's build and run the application. And here we will use the command line or cli.

We have to navigate to the exact project folder

(ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes) and run those following commands,

Build the application,

Command: *dotnet build*

```
PS E:\PracticeProjects\DotnetApi\ReturnTypes&StatusCodes\ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes> dotnet build
Determining projects to restore...
All projects are up-to-date for restore.
ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes -> E:\PracticeProjects\DotnetApi\ReturnTypes&StatusCodes\ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes\bin\Debug\net8.0\ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes.dll

Build succeeded.
    0 Warning(s)
    0 Error(s)

Time Elapsed 00:00:02.64
PS E:\PracticeProjects\DotnetApi\ReturnTypes&StatusCodes\ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes> █
```

To run the application,

Command: *dotnet run* (we usually get the URL from here to see application response).

We can run the project and can directly navigate to application response or Swagger UI.

Use can run the command,

Command: *dotnet watch run*

```
PS E:\PracticeProjects\DotnetApi\ReturnTypes&StatusCodes\ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes> dotnet watch run
dotnet watch 🔥 Hot reload enabled. For a list of supported edits, see https://aka.ms/dotnet/hot-reload.
💡 Press "Ctrl + R" to restart.
dotnet watch 🔨 Building...
Determining projects to restore...
All projects are up-to-date for restore.
ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes -> E:\PracticeProjects\DotnetApi\ReturnTypes&StatusCodes\ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes\bin\Debug\net8.0\ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes.dll
dotnet watch 🚀 Started
info: Microsoft.Hosting.Lifetime[14]
      Now listening on: http://localhost:5169
info: Microsoft.Hosting.Lifetime[0]
      Application started. Press Ctrl+C to shut down.
info: Microsoft.Hosting.Lifetime[0]
      Hosting environment: Development
info: Microsoft.Hosting.Lifetime[0]
      Content root path: E:\PracticeProjects\DotnetApi\ReturnTypes&StatusCodes\ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes
des
█
```

ClothsApi4_ServerErrorStatusCodes

1.0 OAS 3.0

<http://localhost:5169/swagger/v1/swagger.json>

Cloth



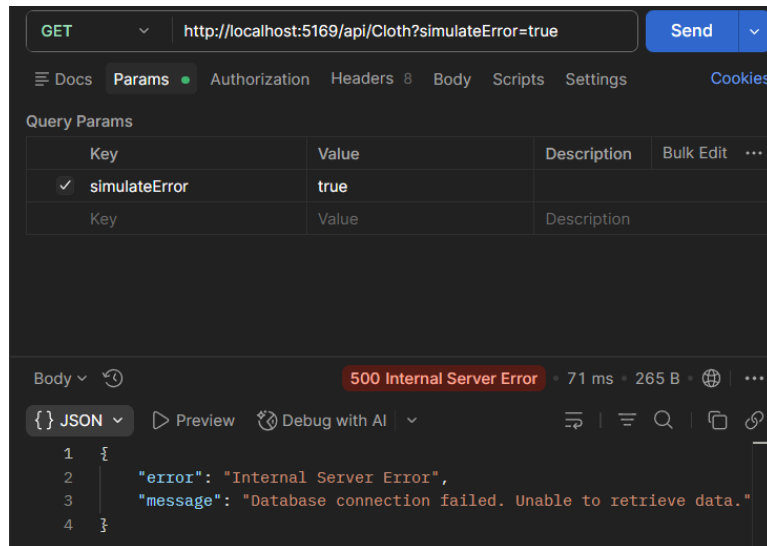
GET	/api/Cloth	▼
POST	/api/Cloth	▼
GET	/api/Cloth/500-manual/{id}	▼
POST	/api/Cloth/bulk	▼
PUT	/api/Cloth/bulk-update	▼
GET	/api/Cloth/upstream	▼
GET	/api/Cloth/maintenance	▼
POST	/api/Cloth/maintenance/toggle	▼
GET	/api/Cloth/all	▼
GET	/api/Cloth/timeout	▼
GET	/api/Cloth/{id}	▼

We are going to use **Postman** here to test our APIs,

Test 1: 500 Internal Server Error – Database Failure

Request: GET <http://localhost:5169/api/Cloth?simulateError=true>

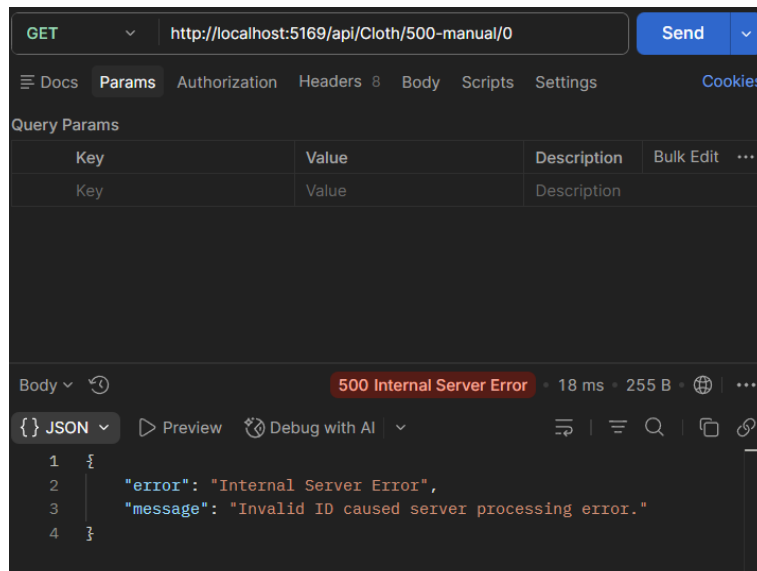
Response (500 Internal Server Error):



Test 2: 500 Internal Server Error - Manual

Request: GET <http://localhost:5169/api/Cloth/500-manual/0>

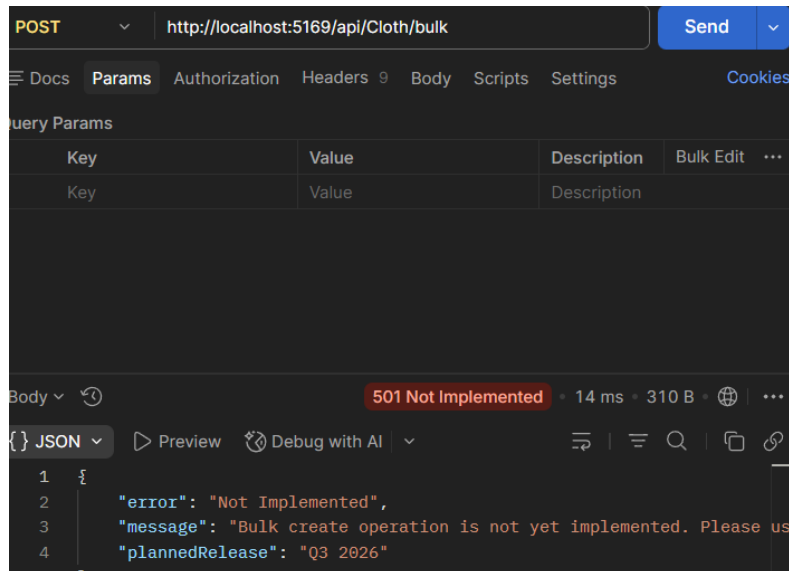
Response (500 Internal Server Error):



Test 3: 501 Not Implemented – Bulk Create

Request: POST <http://localhost:5169/api/Cloth/bulk>

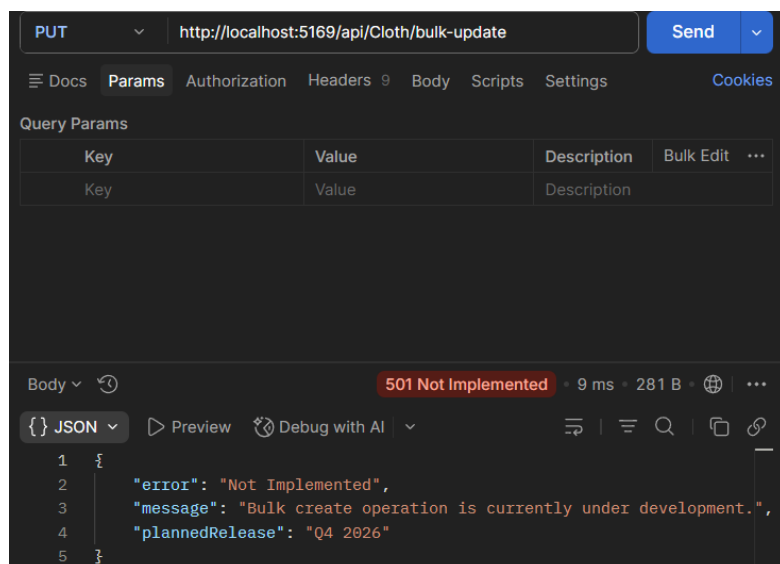
Response (501 Not Implemented):



Test 4: 501 Not Implemented – Bulk Update

Request: PUT <http://localhost:5169/api/Cloth/bulk-update>

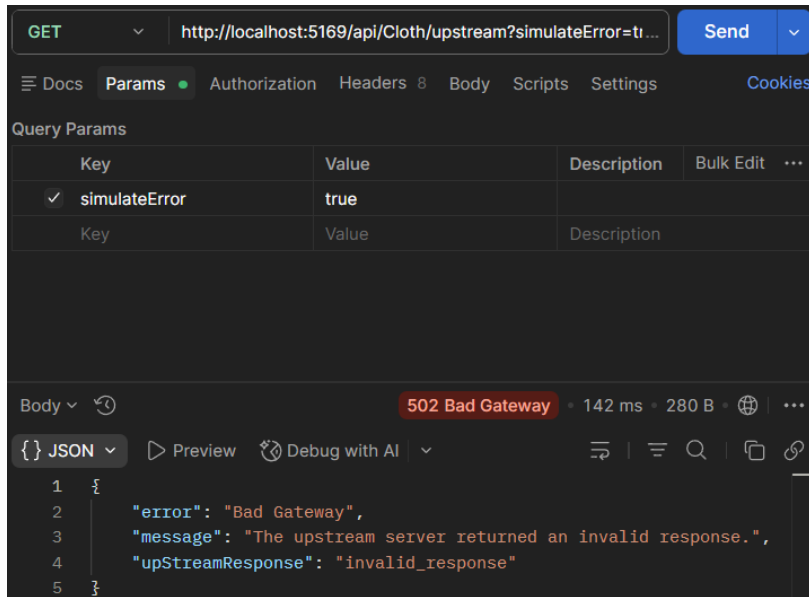
Response (501 Not Implemented):



Test 5: 502 Bad Gateway – Upstream Invalid Response

Request: GET http://localhost:5169/api/Cloth/upstream?simulateError=true

Response (501 Not Implemented):



The screenshot shows a REST client interface with the following details:

- Method:** GET
- URL:** http://localhost:5169/api/Cloth/upstream?simulateError=true
- Send Button:** Send
- Query Params:**

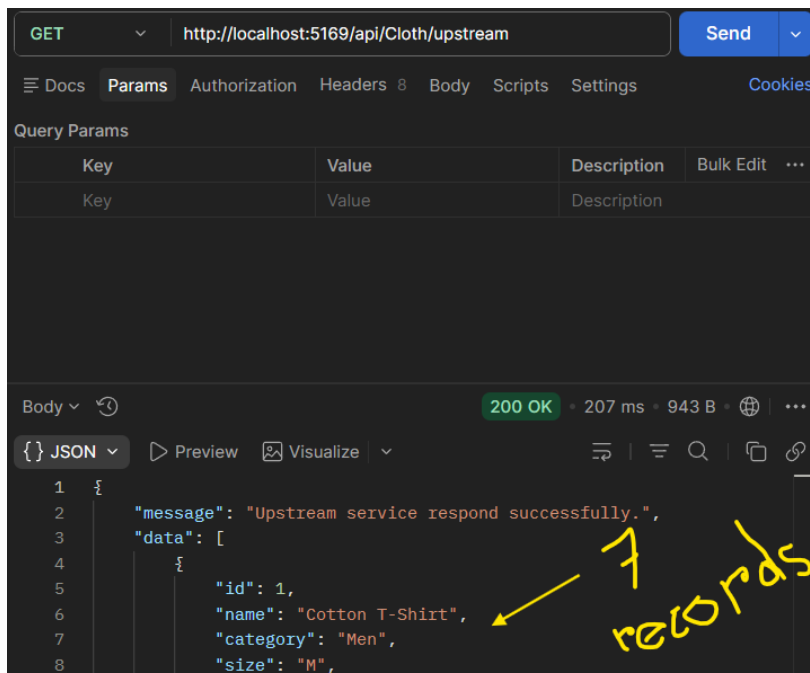
Key	Value	Description	Bulk Edit	...
✓ simulateError	true			
Key	Value	Description		
- Body:** 502 Bad Gateway • 142 ms • 280 B • [Icons]
- JSON Response:**

```
1 {
2   "error": "Bad Gateway",
3   "message": "The upstream server returned an invalid response.",
4   "upStreamResponse": "invalid_response"
5 }
```

Test 6: 502 Bad Gateway – Normal (No Error)

Request: GET http://localhost:5169/api/Cloth/upstream

Response (200 OK):



The screenshot shows a REST client interface with the following details:

- Method:** GET
- URL:** http://localhost:5169/api/Cloth/upstream
- Send Button:** Send
- Query Params:** (Empty table)
- Body:** 200 OK • 207 ms • 943 B • [Icons]
- JSON Response:**

```
1 {
2   "message": "Upstream service respond successfully.",
3   "data": [
4     {
5       "id": 1,
6       "name": "Cotton T-Shirt",
7       "category": "Men",
8       "size": "M",

```

Handwritten note: 7 records (with an arrow pointing to the first record in the data array)

Test 7: 503 Service Unavailable – Enable Maintenance

Request: POST

<http://localhost:5169/api/Cloth/maintenance/toggle?enable=true>

Response (200 OK):

The screenshot shows a REST client interface with the following details:

- Method:** POST
- URL:** <http://localhost:5169/api/Cloth/maintenance/toggle?enable=true>
- Send Button:** A blue button labeled "Send".
- Query Params:** A table with one entry:

Key	Value	Description	Bulk Edit	...
enable	true			
- Body:** A JSON object:

```
{  "message": "Maintenance mode enabled",  "maintenanceMode": true}
```
- Status:** 200 OK, 12 ms, 209 B.

Test 8: 503 Service Unavailable – Check Status

Request: GET <http://localhost:5169/api/Cloth/maintenance>

Response (503 Service Unavailable):

The screenshot shows a REST client interface with the following details:

- Method:** GET
- URL:** <http://localhost:5169/api/Cloth/maintenance>
- Send Button:** A blue button labeled "Send".
- Query Params:** An empty table.
- Body:** A JSON object:

```
{  "error": "Server Unavailable",  "message": "The API is currently under maintenance. Please try again later.",  "estimatedResumeTime": "2026-04-30T14:00:00Z"}
```
- Status:** 503 Service Unavailable, 6 ms, 316 B.

Test 9: 503 Service Unavailable – Try to Access During

Request: GET http://localhost:5169/api/Cloth/all

Response (503 Service Unavailable):

The screenshot shows a REST client interface with the following details:

- Method:** GET
- URL:** http://localhost:5169/api/Cloth/all
- Send Button:** Send
- Tabs:** Docs, Params, Authorization, Headers 8, Body, Scripts, Settings, Cookies
- Query Params:** A table with columns Key, Value, Description, Bulk Edit, and ...
- Body:** 503 Service Unavailable • 12 ms • 272 B • [Globe Icon] • [More Icon]
- JSON View:**

```
{
  "error": "Service Unavailable",
  "message": "The API is currently under maintenance. Please try again"
}
```

Test 10: 503 Service Unavailable – Disable Maintenance

Request: POST

http://localhost:5169/api/Cloth/maintenance/toggle?enable=false

Response (200 OK):

The screenshot shows a REST client interface with the following details:

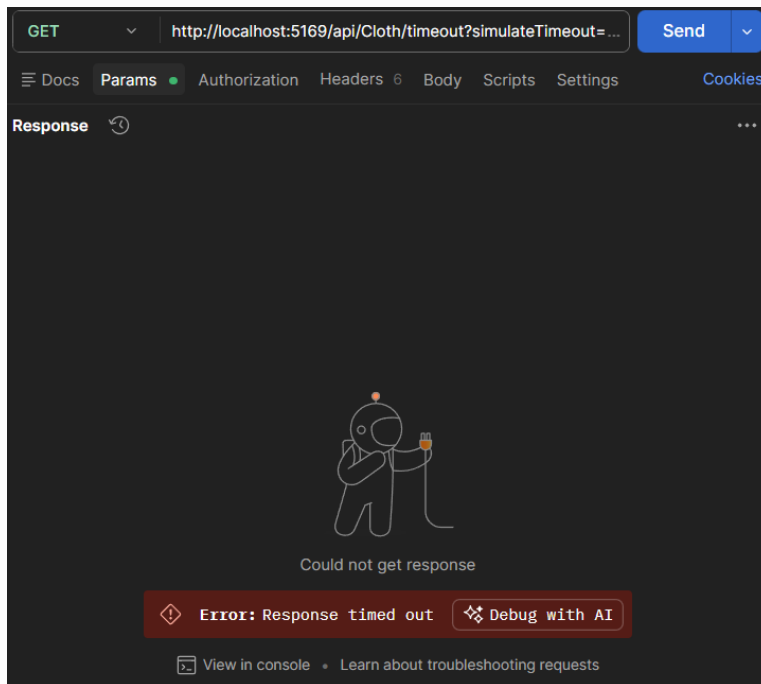
- Method:** POST
- URL:** http://localhost:5169/api/Cloth/maintenance/toggle?enable=false
- Send Button:** Send
- Tabs:** Docs, Params, Authorization, Headers 9, Body, Scripts, Settings, Cookies
- Query Params:** A table with columns Key, Value, Description, Bulk Edit, and ...
- Body:** 200 OK • 4 ms • 211 B • [Globe Icon] • [More Icon]
- JSON View:**

```
{
  "message": "Maintenance mode disabled",
  "maintenanceMode": false
}
```

Test 11: 504 Gateway Timeout – Simulate Timeout

Request: GET <http://localhost:5169/api/Cloth/timeout?simulateTimeout=true>

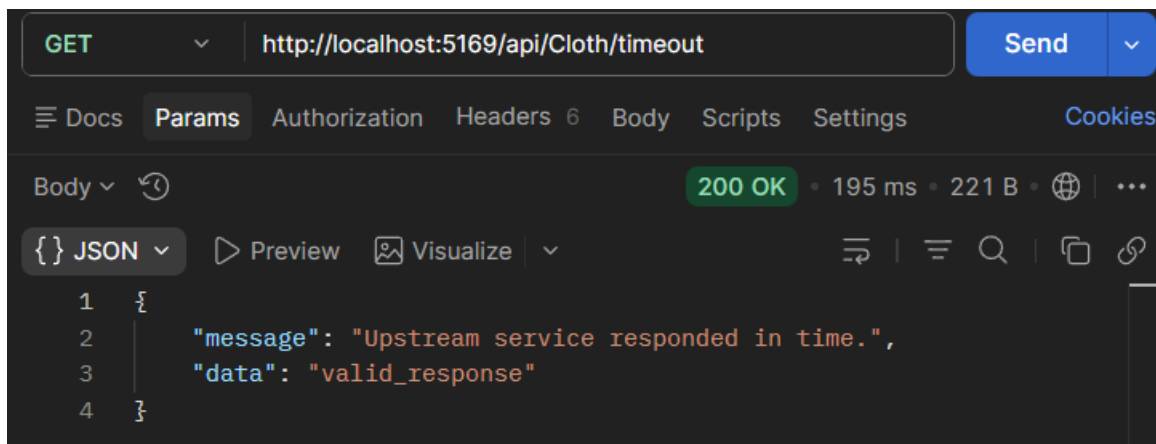
Response (504 Gateway Timeout):



Test 12: 504 Gateway Timeout – Normal (No Timeout)

Request: GET <http://localhost:5169/api/Cloth/timeout>

Response (200 OK):



Test 13: Normal POST Request (Validation)

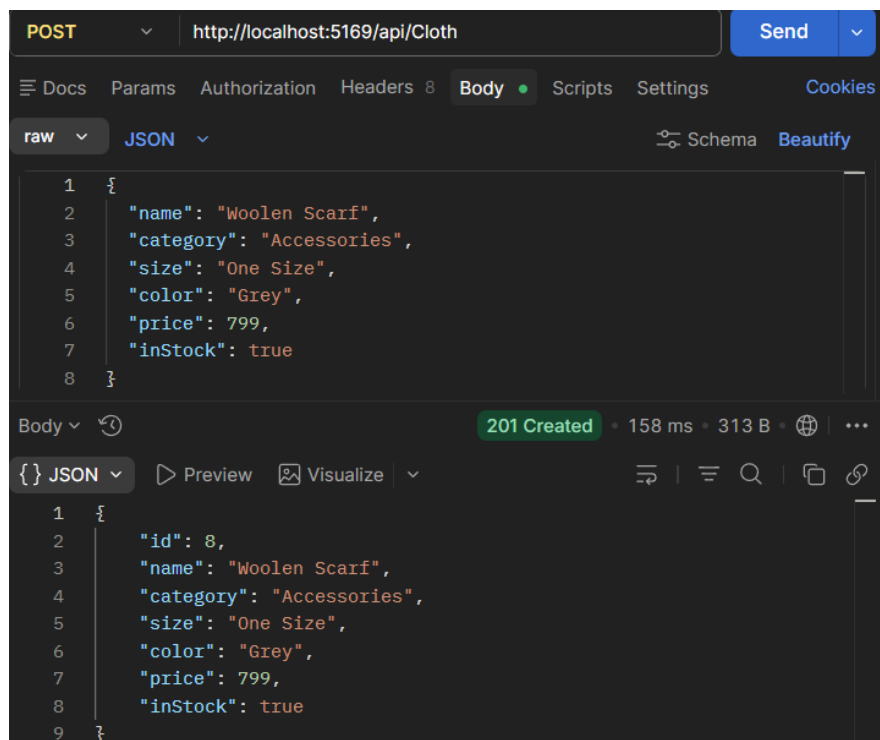
Request: POST http://localhost:5169/api/Cloth

Request Body:

Content-Type: application/json

```
{  
  "name": "Woolen Scarf",  
  "category": "Accessories",  
  "size": "One Size",  
  "color": "Grey",  
  "price": 799,  
  "inStock": true  
}
```

Response (201 Created):



Key Takeaways

Status Code	Names	When to Use	How It Works
500	Internal Server Error	Database failure, unhandled exception, unexpected server condition	Automatic from framework for unhandled exceptions. Can also return manually.
501	Not Implemented	HTTP method not recognized, feature not implemented yet	Always manual. Client should wait for API update or use different endpoint/method.
502	Bad Gateway	Gateway/proxy receives invalid response from upstream server	Manual simulation. Indicates upstream service returned invalid data.
503	Service Unavailable	Maintenance mode, server overload, rate limiting	Always manual. Client should retry later.
504	Gateway Timeout	Gateway/proxy does not receive timely response from upstream server	Manual simulation. Indicates upstream service too slow.